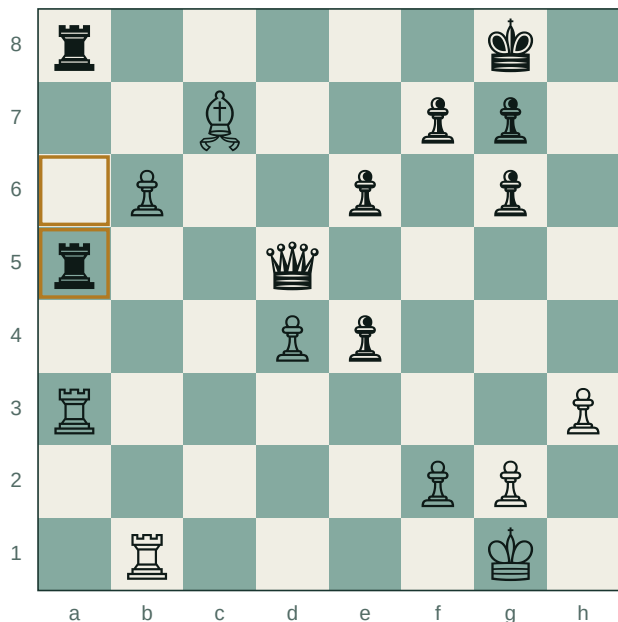


Advanced-pawn tactics: White, move 33

Advanced-pawn tactics

White to move



Previous move: 32...Rxa5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33. Rxa5 Rxa5 34. b7 Qxb7 35. Rxb7 Ra1+ 36. Kh2

33.Rxa5 The rook captures the rook on a5. From a5 it attacks queen on d5 and rook on a8. Recorded reply: **33...Rxa5**.

34.b7 The pawn moves from b6 to b7. The changed line means the bishop on c7 attacks the rook on a5. Recorded reply: **34...Qxb7**.

35.Rxb7 The rook captures the queen on b7. Recorded reply: **35...Ra1+**.

36.Kh2 The king moves from g1 to h2.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +8:** the balance goes from -6 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on g8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.